

A

As well (as), what's more, in addition (to), besides

We often link ideas using *and*, e.g. The food's nice **and** very good value. There are other words and phrases we also use to add more information. Sometimes we still include *and* or *also*.

The restaurant has excellent food; it's **also** very good value.

You always get a good view, *and* the seats are comfortable **as well**. (*syn too*)

As well as getting cheaper tickets, I *also* got the opportunity to buy them in advance.

The clothes are nice, *and* **what's more**, the shop is open every day of the week.

The scheme gives young people experience. **In addition**, companies can afford to employ them.

In addition to the new food department, they're *also* planning to open a café.

Besides being a mum with four children, she's *also* a successful designer.

B

Although, despite, in spite of

We use these link words when there are two ideas in a sentence, and the second is surprising or not expected. They can be used at the beginning or in the middle of the sentence.

Although / **Even though** the sun was shining, it wasn't very warm.

We found the place quite easily, **although** / **even though** we didn't know where it was.

They went for a walk **despite the fact that** it was raining.

Despite having no money, he **still** seemed very happy.

They got there on time **in spite of** the delay.

In spite of all the problems, we **still** enjoyed the trip.

Language help

We can use **still** to emphasise that we didn't expect something to happen or be true, e.g. *He didn't do any work but he **still** passed the exam; The work is very hard, but he **still** enjoys it.*

C

However, yet, though

We can use **however** and **yet** when the second part of an idea is surprising after the first part. *However* is often used to link ideas in two separate sentences. **Though** can be used in a similar way in spoken English, but usually comes at the end of the sentence. Notice the use of commas (,) here, and the different positions of *however*.

I don't agree with a lot of his methods. **However**, he is a very good teacher.

We didn't particularly like the house. The garden, **however**, was wonderful.

It was warm and sunny when we were there. Most of the time, **however**, it's quite cold.

We went in the autumn, **yet** it was still quite warm.

I didn't like the film much. I'm glad I went to see it, **though**.

They told us the shop was next to the station. We never found it, **though**.

D

While and whereas

We can use **while** and **whereas** to compare two different facts or situations.

Alex is very quick to understand, **whereas/while** the others are quite slow.

I get £20 an hour, **while** Josh only gets £12.

The speed limit on this road is 80kph, **whereas** it's 130kph on the motorway.

I was very keen on the film, **whereas** Christoph didn't like it at all.